Lesson 5 — The Two O'Clock Class

Part 5 of 12: The -ing ending and been

Level: A2+ → B1 (fifth step)

About 20 minutes · this part carries a sheet and audio

3.3 The -ing ending, and been (listen to `05-ing-and-been.mp3`)

This tense is three small words joined together, and all three of them shrink in speech. If you cannot hear them, you cannot hear the tense.

1. -ing ends with one sound, not two.

SPELLING	SOUND	NOT THIS
working	/ˈwɜːkɪŋ/	/ˈwɜːkɪn/
teaching	/ˈtiːtʃɪŋ/	/ˈtiːtʃɪn/
learning	/ˈlɜːnɪŋ/	/ˈlɜːnɪn/
repairing	/rɪˈpeərɪŋ/	/rɪˈpeərɪn/
keeping	/ˈkiːpɪŋ/	/ˈkiːpɪn/

The last sound is /ŋ/, made at the back of the mouth with the tongue down. There is no /g/ after it, and it is not /n/ at the front of the mouth.

2. been is weak.

Inside the tense, been is short and quiet: /bɪn/, not /biːn/.

WRITTEN	WHAT YOU ACTUALLY HEAR
She has been working.	/ʃiːz bɪn ˈwɜːkɪŋ/
They have been learning.	/ðeɪv bɪn ˈlɜːnɪŋ/
He has been repairing it.	/hiːz bɪn rɪˈpeərɪŋ ɪt/

So has been working can arrive as one short run of sound. In the audio you hear each one twice, and then a test: say whether what you hear is finished or still going.